



Reconciliation Action Plan 2013-2014



Reconciliation
A U S T R A L I A

St Michael's College

A Catholic Years R-12 School in the tradition of the De La Salle Brothers

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Our Vision for Reconciliation

St Michael's College vision for Reconciliation is for all students to recognise, understand and celebrate Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander culture. This will be observed at the local, national and international level.

Our Virtues of Charity, Tolerance, Mutual Support, Justice, Peace, Sensitivity and Responsibility are features of our Daily Life and therefore support our Educational and Social development.

SMC is committed to providing an education to students that is challenging and supportive of students so that they can strive to "*Be the Best They Can Be*". Hence, all students learn by educating one another through mutual respect, understanding, openness, acceptance of each other and growth in a spirit of service. Acknowledging the Aboriginal culture and supporting Aboriginal students is an important part of the College's Mission in how we all learn together.

There are a number of ways that SMC will continue to recognise and support Aboriginal students which includes;

1. The Promotion and supporting of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students and their families so that they will partake in all facets of College Life.
2. The Continual Development of mutually respectful relationships between Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander and non-Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students, parents/caregivers, teaching and non-teaching staff.
3. Being able to demonstrate an on-going commitment to diversity through recognising the unique and distinctive role of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander culture and heritage on local, national and international levels.
4. The recognition and participation by the school community in important Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander events which include: National Sorry Day, National Reconciliation Week, MABO Day, National NAIDOC Week and International Day of World's Indigenous People.
5. Undertaking to work in partnership with a range of Aboriginal organisations and further education organisations in and around our local community including Tauondi Community College, Charles Sturt Council, TAFE, Tandanya.
6. Providing contact including access to an extensive range of further learning organisations, career pathways programs and tertiary education.
7. The incorporation and recognition of a range of Aboriginal perspectives across and within the curriculum.
8. The development of an on-going awareness of social and cultural Aboriginal issues.
9. The recognition of the on-going contributions of Aboriginal people to enhancing the reputation of the College.

Our School

St Michael's College is a Catholic Reception – Year 12 secondary school situated in the Western suburbs of Adelaide, SA.

The origins of Lasallian education date back to the 17th Century to French priest St John Baptist de La Salle, founder of the Institute of the Brothers of the Christian Schools (De La Salle Brothers).

Born of wealthy parents who valued education, de la Salle responded to the needs of impoverished boys by establishing schools that were open to all, including the socially and economically deprived. Based on the ideal - to provide education for young people that reflects the values of Jesus Christ - de la Salle inspired a tradition that now spans over 80 countries.

St Michael's College was founded in 1954. Classes began at Beverley with 29 boys and rapidly expanded. Today, St Michael's offers boys' education from Reception to Year 7 and co-education in Years 8 to 12.

St Michael's has worked in close partnership with the Missionary of the Sacred Heart Fathers (MSC) throughout its history and they continue to act as Chaplains to the College.

Our Mission from our Lasallian Heritage is: "To touch the hearts of your pupils and inspire them with the Christian spirit is the greatest miracle you can perform." St John Baptist de la Salle, Catholic Church Patron of Teachers, Founder of Lasallian Schools. Our Educational values include: The educational philosophy at St Michael's is designed to support, encourage and inspire students to realise their potential and become high achievers in their chosen fields. The success of St Michael's College is based on an educational ideal that has withstood the test of time for more than three centuries. As a Catholic Lasallian school, St Michael's has an educational program that balances high personal achievement with personal and spiritual growth. The overriding focus is to provide students with a learning experience that allows them to achieve their full potential as highly capable, well-rounded individuals.

St Michael's has developed a learning environment designed to equip students with the skills and confidence to succeed in life and become an integral member of their community. The College's educational philosophy embraces the unique requirements of each individual, including those especially gifted and talented or those who may have special needs.

A broad-based curriculum accommodates a wide range of subjects, an extensive range of Vocational Education and Training (VET) courses and a comprehensive co-curricular program.

Educational values and practices are founded in the Catholic, Lasallian tradition - an education characterised by the core values of:

Faith

Service

Community

Meaningful Learning

Mutual Respect

Reflective Practice

Our Reconciliation Action Plan (RAP)

St Michael's College's Reconciliation Action Plan 2013 – 2014 was developed in consultation with Aboriginal families, local community members and the School Board.

So that Reconciliation is a realistic and achievable goal, this RAP was developed as reflecting the College Community's commitment to Reconciliation based on our school's Core Values. We recognise and celebrate that St Michael's College is on Kurna land and that it is central to our community to acknowledge the Aboriginal culture in our school environment.

St Michael's College staff and students, in partnership with our community, can develop deeper understandings of Aboriginal history and culture so as to forge stronger relationships leading towards Reconciliation. Consultation with Aboriginal Families, Leaders within our local Community and a collaborative approach to Reconciliation is paramount for the development of our RAP.



Relationships

St Michael's College currently has twelve Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students of who are part of the College Community.

It is important to our working relationship that all participants at the College can work together collaboratively to achieve our educational goals. To work with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people and communities is something that we take great pride in as together we can overcome any challenges that we encounter and build relationships based on mutual respect.

Our vision of Reconciliation is based strongly on developing and enhancing relationships with all students and where possible provide full support where needed to our Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander population. Relationships are the corner stone and springboard for collaboratively achieving our vision of "Being the Best You Can Be."

As St Michael's College continues to acknowledge the traditional owners of this land, we will also continue to celebrate Aboriginal culture and heritage as part of the College Community. We believe it is important to foster an ongoing awareness of Aboriginal culture and heritage and to participate in celebrating significant milestones in Aboriginal history. We also believe that this will then contribute to stronger relationships and thus lead towards our vision for Reconciliation in the College Community.

St Michael's College strives to have positive collaborative relationships positive which, in turn, lead to having successful and fruitful outcomes for the whole College Community. In establishing, building and fostering relationships, it is important for the College Community to spend time, formally and informally, working together towards our vision for Reconciliation. Open & honest communication with all members of our College Community is important in building positive and constructive relationships between students, parents and caregivers, colleagues, and members of the wider community.

St Michael's College respects and celebrates the Kurna people as the traditional keepers of this land that we share. We invite the whole College Community to be involved in our Reconciliation Mass that brings together Aboriginal and Non-Aboriginal people in the celebration of Jesus Christ. We respect the Aboriginal Spirituality with the Dreaming as being paramount to the identity of all Aboriginal people. We aim to educate all of the College Community in understanding and respecting Aboriginal Spirituality as a significant part of our vision towards Reconciliation.

Focus Area (Optional)

ACTION – Establish a committee to develop, monitor, review and refresh the Reconciliation Action Plan. This committee should include:

- The College Principal (or delegate)
- Teachers/staff from across stages and/or departments.
- Students (Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander and non-Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander)
- Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community members.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
Deputy Principal (Pastoral) Deputy Principal (Primary) Director of Pastoral Administration Aboriginal Focus Teachers Primary/Secondary Year 12 College Leaders Year 11 LYL Parents/families College Community	Term 2 – 4	• RAP Committee established. • Two RAP Committee meetings held each year. • Minutes and “action items” recorded for all meetings. • The RAP is reviewed and refreshed annually using Reconciliation Australia’s Tracking and Reporting Tool. • Meet at least twice per year.

ACTION – Invite Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Community Members to be involved with College committees.

Include parents, teachers, students and community leaders.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
College Executive Student Peers	Ongoing	• Organise at least one internal event each year. • Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander appointments to and/or designated Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander positions on the: Parent Group Student Representative Council School Board

ACTION – Establish, build and foster relationships with our College’s Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
RAP Committee Aboriginal Focus Teachers Primary and Secondary Heads of Department	Ongoing	• All students will have the opportunity to visit Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander sites and/or events associated with the celebration of their culture. In addition, we will encourage all students to be involved in community activities and festivals as part of Aboriginal perspectives in curriculum areas. • The College Community will support students participating in local Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community events as well as utilising The Star (College Newsletter) to promote any and all community events. • The College website will also be utilised to promote all significant events as well as to highlight the achievements of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students within the College Community.

Respect

As a College Community, we will continue to respect Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people as being the First Australians. We continue to acknowledge the traditional owners through our support of National Sorry Day, National Reconciliation Week, Mabo Day, National NAIDOC Week and International Day of World's Indigenous People. Students will receive Certificates of Achievement at the completion of Year 10 with the whole College Community.

Focus Area *(optional)*

ACTION – Publicly display our school's respect for, and knowledge of, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Island peoples, cultures and histories.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
All staff and students Visual and Performing Arts Department Aboriginal Focus Teachers Primary and Secondary	2013 Ongoing	• The recognition of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander totems including poles and flags flown on days and weeks of cultural significance. • Acknowledgment by the College Community that we meet on Kurna Land at the beginning of College Assemblies. • Planning, design and erection of Recognition poles in the Kurna area of the College. • The recognition and celebration of all significant Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander events throughout the year. • We will continue to display elements of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Art and Culture throughout the College Community.

ACTION – Staff will receive information that will assist and add to their current knowledge of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander History and Culture.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
CEO Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Education Team Aboriginal Focus Teacher Primary and Secondary Aboriginal Parents	Ongoing	• Our college will join the “Close the Gap” program during 2013.

ACTION – Include Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples perspective in a range of curriculum areas.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
Teaching and Learning Years R – 12	Ongoing	We will continue to include and develop Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander content in the teaching of all curriculum areas across the College. We will further develop our Resource Centre materials that relate to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples which will include the acquisition of books by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander authors. Other resource material to be further developed will include the recording of current affairs programs dedicated to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander issues that could be recent and/or historical. Workshops will be offered to students so that they have the opportunity to interact with Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander peoples, on different levels, to assist in developing an understanding of Aboriginal life in our local environment.

Opportunities

Providing opportunities for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students to become “The Best they can Be” is a major goal of St Michael’s College and this is important to all participants as we move towards Reconciliation. We continue to support students in their education in the College Community and we encourage all students to participate in Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander programs that will add to their knowledge of their History and Culture.

We will work in collaboration with students and their families to develop an insight into where we can best support individual student learning. Once we identify the areas that we can best support students, we will then create opportunities that will enhance student’s individual learning.

Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students will have their pathways to learning identified and developed to suit their needs for the future.

The College community will provide Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students with opportunities for participating in our leadership programs such as: Becoming a Class/Student Leader; be involved with the Lasallian Youth Leadership Program and selection as a College Leader. Parents will be offered the opportunity to participate on the School Board. Students will also be offered the opportunity to encourage greater awareness of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander People within the College Community.

Focus area: *(optional)*

ACTION – Support Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students to reach their full potential.

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
Subject Teachers VET Pathways Coordinator SACE Coordinator Aboriginal Focus Teachers Primary and Secondary Counsellors – Personal and Careers YLDs and AYLDs HoDs	2013 – ongoing	• Policies that are based on Anti-racism will be clearly stated and promoted via the College. • The College’s strategic plan will recognise and meet the needs of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students. • Access to scholarships/traineeships, tutoring, financial support, career advice and mentoring for all Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students and their families will be promoted. • Resources for Teachers will be identified, evaluated and implemented so as to assist in the teaching of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students. • Formation of Inclusive Education Plans for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Island students falling below benchmarks.

Tracking Progress and Reporting

ACTION – Monitor and refresh our Reconciliation Action Plan

Responsibility	Timeline	Target
Monitor and refresh our Reconciliation Action Plan	2014	• Our Reconciliation Action Plan is monitored by our RAP Committee and presented to the College Board and the Pastoral and Curriculum Committees. • Our RAP is evaluated at the end of each College year and planning is undertaken for the upcoming year for the implementation of set goals and objectives.